

DATA 505 (Statistics Using R): Exam 1

Part 2: Open Computer

Name: *Edona Halilaj*_____

2025-09-30

Instructions

Welcome to Part 2 of the exam!

You now have access to your computer and any online resources that are “not alive” (i.e., you may freely use online resources, but you may not communicate with any other person). You have approximately 45 minutes to complete this part.

Fill in the code chunks below and provide written answers where requested. Submit this completed .qmd file on Moodle along with the rendered PDF.

Setup and Data Loading

We will analyze data about Antarctic penguins from the Palmer Station research program. The data are available in the `palmerpenguins` R package.

```
# Install and load the required packages
if(!"palmerpenguins" %in% installed.packages()){
  install.packages("palmerpenguins")
}
if(!"ggplot2" %in% installed.packages()){
  install.packages("ggplot2")
}

library(palmerpenguins)
library(ggplot2)

# Load the penguins data
data("penguins")
```

Data Exploration (4 points)

1 (2 points)

Use the `str()` function to examine the structure of the penguins dataset.

```
str(penguins)
```

```
tibble [344 x 8] (S3: tbl_df/tbl/data.frame)
 $ species      : Factor w/ 3 levels "Adelie","Chinstrap",...: 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 ...
 $ island       : Factor w/ 3 levels "Biscoe","Dream",...: 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 ...
 $ bill_length_mm : num [1:344] 39.1 39.5 40.3 NA 36.7 39.3 38.9 39.2 34.1 42 ...
 $ bill_depth_mm  : num [1:344] 18.7 17.4 18 NA 19.3 20.6 17.8 19.6 18.1 20.2 ...
 $ flipper_length_mm: int [1:344] 181 186 195 NA 193 190 181 195 193 190 ...
 $ body_mass_g    : int [1:344] 3750 3800 3250 NA 3450 3650 3625 4675 3475 4250 ...
 $ sex           : Factor w/ 2 levels "female","male": 2 1 1 NA 1 2 1 2 NA NA ...
 $ year          : int [1:344] 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 ...
```

How many observations and variables are there?

Answer: 344 observations (rows) → each row represents one penguin. 8 variables (columns) → species, island, bill_length_mm, bill_depth_mm, flipper_length_mm, body_mass_g, sex, and year

2 (2 points)

Extract the `bill_length_mm` column from the penguins dataset and store it in a new variable called `bill_lengths`. Then use the `summary()` function to examine this variable.

```
bill_lengths <- penguins$bill_length_mm
```

```
summary(bill_lengths)
```

Min.	1st Qu.	Median	Mean	3rd Qu.	Max.	NA's
32.10	39.23	44.45	43.92	48.50	59.60	2

Research Question

We want to investigate whether the mean bill length of Adelie penguins differs significantly from 39 mm. This research question is motivated by previous studies suggesting that 39 mm might be a typical bill length for this species.

1 (4 points)

Filter the dataset to include only Adelie penguins and store the result in a new variable called `adelie_penguins`. Remove any rows with missing bill length measurements.

```
adelie_penguins <- subset(penguins, species == "Adelie" & !is.na(bill_length_mm))
```

2 (3 points)

Extract the bill lengths from the Adelie penguin data and store them in a variable called `adelie_bills`. How many Adelie penguins have complete bill length measurements?

```
adelie_bills <- adelic_penguins$bill_length_mm  
  
length(adelie_bills)
```

```
[1] 151
```

Number of Adelie penguins with complete data: 151

3 (5 points)

Calculate the following descriptive statistics for Adelie penguin bill lengths: - Mean - Standard deviation

- Median - 25th and 75th percentiles

```
# Mean  
mean(adelie_bills)
```

```
[1] 38.79139
```

```
# Standard deviation  
sd(adelie_bills)
```

```
[1] 2.663405
```

```
# Median  
median(adelie_bills)
```

```
[1] 38.8
```

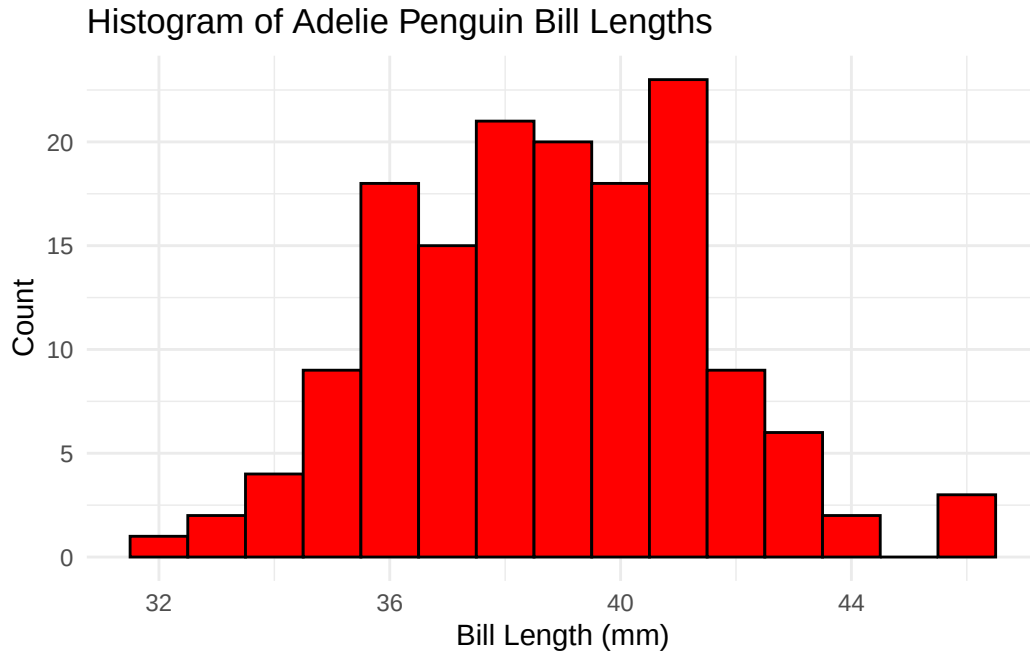
```
# 25th and 75th percentiles  
quantile(adelie_bills, c(0.25, 0.75))
```

```
    25%    75%  
36.75 40.75
```

4 (5 points)

Create a histogram of Adelie penguin bill lengths using ggplot2 or base R. Include appropriate axis labels and a title.

```
ggplot(adelie_penguins, aes(x = bill_length_mm)) +  
  geom_histogram(binwidth = 1, fill = "red", color = "black") +  
  labs(  
    title = "Histogram of Adelie Penguin Bill Lengths",  
    x = "Bill Length (mm)",  
    y = "Count"  
  ) +  
  theme_minimal()
```



Based on the histogram, briefly describe the distribution of bill lengths (address shape, center, and spread):

Description: The distribution is roughly bell-shaped and fairly symmetric. The distribution centers around 39 mm, which is consistent with the sample mean and median we calculated (both close to 38.8–39.0 mm). Most bill lengths fall between 36 and 42 mm, with a few outliers on both the lower and upper ends.

Statistical Analysis

1 (5 points)

Now we will formally test whether the population mean bill length μ differs from 39 inches, i.e. we will test:

$$H_0 : \mu = 39$$

against

$$H_A : \mu \neq 39$$

Perform a two-sided t-test to test these hypotheses. Use $\alpha = 0.05$.

```
t.test(adelie_bills, mu = 39, alternative = "two.sided")
```

One Sample t-test

```
data: adelie_bills
t = -0.96246, df = 150, p-value = 0.3374
alternative hypothesis: true mean is not equal to 39
95 percent confidence interval:
 38.36312 39.21966
sample estimates:
mean of x
 38.79139
```

Based on your test results, what is your conclusion? Interpret the results in the context of the research question.

Conclusion: Since the p-value ($0.337 > 0.05$), we fail to reject the null hypothesis. There is no significant evidence that the mean bill length of Adelie penguins differs from 39 mm. The average bill length of Adelie penguins in this sample (38.79 mm) is not statistically different from the hypothesized value of 39 mm.

2 (4 points)

Define another variable (a numeric vector) `confidence_interval` and assign as its value the two bounds (lower and upper) of a 95% confidence interval for the mean bill length of Adelie penguins. Print the result. Full points are possible only if you do not “hard code” the bounds for the interval, i.e. if you create this vector directly by using R functions applied to the dataset. Half points maximum if you define the vector by typing the entries manually.

```
confidence_interval <- t.test(adelie_bills, mu = 39)$conf.int
confidence_interval
```

```
[1] 38.36312 39.21966
attr(,"conf.level")
[1] 0.95
```